

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Architecture | Cloud Security | Risk and Threat Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and managing enterprise security architectures and controls across complex, multi-site organisations undergoing significant technology and cloud transformation. I have led threat modelling exercises, security risk assessments, and security reviews across cloud, infrastructure, and application domains, and I bring strong experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Identity and Access Management (IAM), endpoint protection, and vulnerability management. My technical depth spans Microsoft Azure cloud security, CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and a broad range of security controls aligned to frameworks including the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, and ISO 27001. I communicate complex security risks clearly to senior stakeholders and consistently act as a trusted technical expert across business-critical projects and large-scale transformation programmes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Architecture and Design:** Security architecture design and review, control implementation, security standards development, stakeholder engagement at executive and project level
- **Threat Modelling and Risk Assessment:** Structured threat modelling, information security risk assessments, security reviews for cloud and infrastructure projects
- **Cloud Security (Microsoft Azure):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), cloud workload protection, hybrid cloud environments
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, role-based access control (RBAC), privileged access management (BeyondTrust PAM), least-privilege enforcement
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Next-Generation SIEM, alert triage, detection engineering
- **Endpoint Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, and Discover (8,000-user deployment); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM
- **Network Security:** Firewall management (Check Point Harmony), intrusion detection and prevention (IDS/IPS), network segmentation, Web Application Firewall (WAF)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK, threat hunting, forensic triage, post-incident reviews
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls v8, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Design and implement security architectures and controls across a complex multi-site environment of 8,000 users, aligning technical security delivery to the organisation's cloud adoption and digital transformation strategy.
- Drive security best practices across all projects, acting as the senior technical expert on security engineering and advising project teams on secure-by-design principles from inception through to delivery.
- Lead threat modelling, information security risk assessments, and security reviews for cloud, infrastructure, and application initiatives, ensuring risks are identified, documented, and mitigated early in the project lifecycle.

- Support cloud and infrastructure security initiatives within the Microsoft Azure environment, managing Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) for 8,000 users.
- Manage the CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform including Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, and Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) modules, ensuring continuous endpoint visibility and threat prevention.
- Oversee the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment, authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules and SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage and incident response workflows.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege principles and govern administrator access across the hybrid environment.
- Lead the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), producing risk-based remediation plans for infrastructure and application owners.
- Conduct threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework to proactively identify threats and reduce the organisation's exposure to advanced persistent threats.
- Present security risk posture, programme progress, and incident summaries to senior leadership and governance committees, translating technical findings into clear business language.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Supported the design and implementation of security controls across identity, endpoint, and network domains, contributing to the organisation's evolving security architecture.
- Performed SIEM alert triage and security event investigation using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike, escalating confirmed incidents and recommending control improvements.
- Assisted with cloud security initiatives in Microsoft Azure, administering Entra ID / Azure AD user accounts, group policies, and Conditional Access configurations.
- Supported application and infrastructure security reviews as part of project delivery, advising teams on security requirements and control implementation.
- Administered Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies to enforce device compliance across the enterprise.
- Assisted with vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, producing remediation reports and tracking progress against identified risks.
- Contributed to the development of security policies, standards, and procedures aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security architecture, quality engineering, and infrastructure management across a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, implementing security controls aligned to ISO 27001.
- Conducted security risk assessments and contributed to information security management system (ISMS) documentation, policies, and procedures.
- Managed identity and access controls, endpoint security, and network security configurations across the cloud-first environment.
- Supported business-critical infrastructure projects, providing security engineering input and advising on secure configuration and access management best practices.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise-wide deployment and hardening of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, delivering unified Extended Detection and Response (XDR) coverage as part of a major cloud transformation programme.
- Designed and delivered a structured vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, enabling risk-based prioritisation and measurably reducing the organisation's attack surface.
- Established threat modelling and security review processes for large-scale infrastructure and cloud migration projects, identifying and remediating critical security risks before system go-live.

- Implemented SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, streamlining alert triage and incident response workflows and reducing manual analyst effort by over 40%.
- Developed and maintained the organisation's Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation programme, producing evidence packs and implementing remediation actions to achieve and sustain certification.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Leeds/UK)